

03. The Making of a Global World

Session 01 –

01. Define globalization.

Globalization is defined as the free movement of people and goods across the nations.

02. How were cowries used in the ancient periods?

For more than a millennia, cowries (the Hindi cowdi or seashells, used as a form of currency) from the Maldives found their way to China and East Africa.

03. Give two examples of different types of global exchanges which took place before the 7th century, choosing example from Asia and one from America.

The examples of the different global exchanges which took place before the 7th century are as follows –

- Textile, spices and Chinese pottery were exchanged by China and Southeast Asia in for gold and silver from Europe.
- Gold and foods such as potatoes, soya, groundnuts, tomatoes and chillies were exported from the America to Europe.

04. What does the silk route refer to? Through which route the early Christian missionaries travelled to Asia? [If the question is only silk route, then write the first part]

OR

Trade and cultural exchange always went hand in hand. Explain.

OR

The silk route are a good example of trade and culture between distant parts of the world. Explain.

Silk Route, ancient trade route, linking China with the west that carried goods and ideas between two great civilizations of Rome and China.

- The silk routes during the pre-modern period had vibrant trade and cultural links between distant parts of the world.
- The name 'silk routes' points to the importance of West-bound Chinese silk cargoes along this route.
- Historians have identified several silk routes, over land and by sea, knitting together vast regions of Asia, and linking Asia with Europe and northern Africa.
- Chinese pottery also travelled the same route, as did textiles and spices from India and Southeast Asia. In return, precious metals – gold and silver – flowed from Europe to Asia.
- Trade and cultural exchange always went hand in hand. Early Christian missionaries almost certainly travelled this route to Asia, as did early Muslim preachers a few centuries later. Much before all this, Buddhism emerged from eastern India and spread in several directions through intersecting points on the silk routes.

05. How did food habits travelled from one place to another in the process of cultural exchange?

- Food offers many examples of long-distance cultural exchange. Traders and travellers introduced new crops to the lands they travelled.
- Take spaghetti and noodles. It is believed that noodles travelled west from China to become spaghetti. Or, perhaps Arab traders took pasta to fifth-century Sicily, an island now in Italy.
- Many of our common foods such as potatoes, soya, groundnuts, maize, tomatoes, chillies, sweet potatoes, and so on were not known to our ancestors until about five centuries ago.

03. The Making of a Global World

These foods were only introduced in Europe and Asia after Christopher Columbus accidentally discovered the vast continent that would later become known as the Americas.

06. Which food travelled west from China to be called spaghetti?

Noodles.

07. Name the crops which our ancestors did not grow until about five centuries ago.

Many of our common foods such as potatoes, soya, groundnuts, maize, tomatoes, chillies, sweet potatoes, and so on were not known to our ancestors until about five centuries ago. These foods were only introduced in Europe and Asia after Christopher Columbus accidentally discovered the vast continent that would later become known as the Americas.

08. Who discovered America?

Christopher Columbus accidentally discovered the vast continent that would later become known as the Americas.

09. The introduction of which crop led the European poor to eat better and live longer?

Europe's poor began to eat better and live longer with the introduction of the humble potato. Ireland's poorest peasants became so dependent on potatoes that when disease destroyed the potato crop in the mid-1840s, hundreds of thousands died of starvation.

10. What is El Dorado in South America?

It was an imaginary land of great wealth, the fable city of gold.

11. Which European countries first conquered America?

Portuguese and Spanish.

12. Which powerful weapon was used by Spanish to conquer America?

The Portuguese and Spanish conquest and colonisation of America was decisively under way by the mid-sixteenth century. European conquest was not just a result of superior firepower. In fact, the most powerful weapon of the Spanish conquerors was not a conventional military weapon at all. It was the germs such as those of smallpox that they carried on their person. Because of their long isolation, America's original inhabitants had no immunity against these diseases that came from Europe.

13. Explain with the help of examples that the pre-modern world changed with the discovery of new sea routes to America.

- Many of our common foods such as potatoes, soya, etc. were introduced to Europe by America. These crops made difference between life and death, the poor began to eat better and live longer in Ireland with the introduction of potatoes.
- Precious metals, particularly silver from mines, located in the present-day Peru and Mexico also enhanced Europe's wealth and financed its trade with Asia.
- Slave trade started. European traders captured slaves in Africa and took them to America where they worked in plantations. Europe became the center of world trade.
- Religious dissenters were persecuted in Europe. Thousands flee from Europe for America.
- Diseases like smallpox, germs of which were carried by Europeans to America decimated the whole community who had no immunity to it.

-THE END-

Sources – NCERT: Class 10 textbook for History – India and the Contemporary World-II

Questions by Binita Jain ma'am: History teacher, BMSSS.

- Aayan